BALAJI PALANI

Senior Scrum Master | Technical Agile Delivery Lead

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🔗 linkedin.com/in/balajipalani92 ✓ Immediate Joiner (0 Days Notice)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Certified Senior Scrum Master (CSM®, SAFe® 6 SSM) with **7+ years of IT experience**, combining 4+ years of dedicated Agile delivery leadership with a strong technical foundation in software engineering (React.js, AWS, REST APIs). Proven track record of orchestrating cross-functional teams (up to 25+ engineers) across **BFSI, FinTech, and Telecom** domains. Expert in facilitating Scrum and SAFe ceremonies, driving Agile Release Trains (ART), resolving complex cross-team dependencies, and raising sprint delivery predictability from ~68% to 88%+. Skilled in building automated Jira/Power BI delivery dashboards, coaching teams on story slicing (INVEST), and bridging technical engineering squads with executive business stakeholders.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified ScrumMaster® (CSM)
Scrum Alliance • Credential ID: 2022

SAFe® 6 Scrum Master (SSM)
Scaled Agile Inc. • Credential ID: 2023

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Agile Frameworks & Scaling: Scrum, Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe 6.0), Kanban, Scrum of Scrums (SoS), Lean Agile, Agile Release Train (ART) facilitation.

Ceremonies & Delivery Management: Sprint Planning, Daily Stand-ups, Backlog Refinement, Sprint Retrospectives, Sprint Reviews, PI Planning, Release Planning, Capacity Forecasting.

Coaching & Process Governance: Definition of Ready (DoR), Definition of Done (DoD), User Story Slicing (INVEST criteria), Relative Estimation, Blocker Resolution SLAs, Team Health Assessments.

Agile Tools & Analytics: Atlassian Jira (Advanced JQL, Automation Rules, Workflow Schemes, Board Setup), Confluence, Azure DevOps (ADO), Power BI, Miro, Trello.

Technical Engineering Literacy: Software Engineering Lifecycle (SDLC), CI/CD flow, Git branching strategies, AWS Cloud (S3, Amplify, ECS), React.js, Web Architecture, Microservices & REST APIs.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MITS Global Consulting
07/2024 – 03/2026

Senior Scrum Master
Client: UK BFSI & FinTech Programme • Mumbai, India

- **Multi-Team Delivery Leadership:** Facilitated Agile delivery across 3 distributed cross-functional Scrum teams (25+ engineers, QA, and UI/UX designers) delivering critical digital banking and financial software releases.
- **Requirement Readiness & Process Flow:** Implemented automated Definition of Ready (DoR) and Acceptance Criteria validation in Jira, reducing sprint planning cycle overhead by 30% and eliminating mid-sprint requirement ambiguity.
- **Predictability & Velocity Stabilization:** Raised sprint goal delivery predictability from 68% to 88% over consecutive quarters by introducing structured retrospectives (4Ls, Sailboat) and enforcing accountable impediment tracking.
- **Agile Coaching & Mentorship:** Mentored 2 junior Scrum Masters on Agile maturity diagnostics, team health-check frameworks, and collaborative story point estimation techniques, driving sustainable team autonomy.
- **Backlog Refinement & Story Slicing:** Facilitated weekly estimation and user story slicing workshops with Product Owners, breaking complex epics into vertical, testable slices and improving team delivery flow.
- **Automated Metrics & Executive Reporting:** Designed and maintained automated Jira and Power BI delivery dashboards (Cycle Time, Cumulative Flow, Sprint Burndown), providing executive leadership and client directors with real-time risk visibility.
- **Dependency & Impediment Resolution:** Established a centralized dependency tracker across shared QA, DevOps, and vendor services, resolving cross-team blockers within a strict 48-hour SLA to guarantee milestone delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Incedo Inc
09/2023 – 03/2024

Scrum Master (SAFe Delivery)
Client: Verizon (Telecom) • Mumbai, India

- **Enterprise SAFe Execution:** Led end-to-end Agile execution for a 10-member cross-functional engineering team within Verizon's enterprise SAFe framework, ensuring alignment with program-level milestones.
- **PI Planning & ART Coordination:** Orchestrated objectives, cross-team dependencies, and program risks across 2 Program Increment (PI) Planning events involving 5 Agile squads across the Agile Release Train (ART).
- **Scrum of Scrums (SoS):** Represented the team in bi-weekly Scrum of Scrums, proactively identifying and escalating cross-train bottlenecks, shared infrastructure constraints, and cross-team interface dependencies.
- **Product Backlog Refinement:** Partnered with Product Owners to lead bi-weekly backlog grooming, maintaining a prepared, estimated, and prioritized backlog of 20+ user stories ready 2 sprints ahead.
- **Ceremony Facilitation:** Led high-impact Daily Standups, Sprint Planning, Sprint Reviews, and Retrospectives, driving measurable improvements in sprint focus and cross-team collaboration.
- **Stakeholder Visibility:** Generated bi-weekly sprint health reports and delivery metrics for 10+ senior business and engineering stakeholders, enabling timely scope adjustments and risk remediation.

CDP360 Technologies Pvt Ltd
06/2022 – 07/2023

Scrum Master
Chennai / Remote, India

- **Cross-Functional Delivery:** Led Agile delivery for a dedicated engineering team (6 Developers, 2 QA Engineers) across international E-commerce, EdTech, and FinTech digital products, successfully shipping 6 major client releases.
- **Workflow Optimization:** Reconfigured Jira and Trello board workflows, transitions, and automated notification rules, eliminating communication friction and establishing clear stakeholder delivery visibility.
- **Scope Stability & Story Quality:** Collaborated with Product Owners to institute unambiguous Acceptance Criteria, slashing mid-sprint scope changes by 30% and reducing carried-forward spillover stories from 10 to under 3 per sprint.
- **Technical Barrier Elimination:** Leveraged software engineering background to help developers diagnose and resolve deployment bottlenecks across AWS cloud services (S3, Amplify, ECS) and React Native mobile builds.
- **Continuous Retrospective Action:** Facilitated targeted retrospectives focused on root-cause analysis, fostering psychological safety and establishing measurable team agreements.

Azure Soft Tech Solutions
12/2018 – 05/2022

Frontend Developer (Agile Engineer)
Chennai, India

- **Modern Web & Mobile Engineering:** Architected and developed 15+ scalable web and mobile applications using React.js, React Native, Redux, and modern JavaScript toolchains across customer-facing digital platforms.
- **Cloud Deployment:** Automated deployments of 10+ production applications on AWS infrastructure (S3, Amplify, ECS), maintaining CI/CD pipeline stability and zero-downtime releases.
- **Agile Team Participation:** Actively contributed to daily stand-ups, story estimation (Planning Poker), and sprint planning, bridging technical implementation feasibility with business acceptance criteria.
- **Code Quality & Process Efficiency:** Advocated for automated unit testing, pull request code reviews, and reusable component libraries, reducing production defects and accelerating feature delivery cycles.

INDUSTRY DOMAIN EXPERTISE

Banking, Financial Services & FinTech (BFSI)
Digital banking channels, payment workflows, financial transaction compliance, secure microservices architecture.

Telecommunications & Enterprise Platforms
Multi-vendor systems, enterprise SAFe ART synchronization, high-availability customer-facing platforms (Verizon).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Computer Science and Engineering
2012 – 2016

Anna University • Chennai, India